

DSC Branding Guidelines Brief

June 2026

Resources

- [Solid Digital BG](#)
- [HermanMiller BG](#)

- [DSC Company Ethos Document](#)
- [DSC Marketing Position Document](#)

Phases

Brand Foundation

Who Are We?

- Establish the critical distinction of the brand. What's the authentic brand truth?
- What motivates the brand and what is the embodiment of that essence as a character
- Sit with leadership to understand their perspective and expectations.
- Who is this brand trying to connect with? We need to understand customer needs and drivers
- Competitive landscape – secondary and via org's own pov (vs. OrthoLight)
- Purpose, Mission, Promise, Position, Character, Vision, and who we're connecting with

Brand / Product Architecture

What Is our Structure?

- Becomes essential when a B2B brand wants to stretch or especially move towards B2C
- Naming, whether the master brand, sub-brands, product lines or technology platforms is established here
- Set the stage here for growth over time, flexibility without letting things get out of control, which often happens when brands lose sight of hierarchy and all the sudden everyone is naming all the babies without consistency or falling into over-propagation traps

We are here?
Hold that thought!



Brand Guidelines / Expression

How Do We Show Up?

- Identity, color, fonts, photography, etc
- Messaging architecture
- Reference touch points such as web, marketing, etc.

Brand Execution

How Do We Consistently Deliver?

- e.g. Product, web, packaging, trade show, communications, collateral, marketing, etc. etc.

But need to be over here...

And then from here on, things are way more streamlined...

Introduction slide references

Introduction

Title: DSC® Brand Guidelines

Subtext:

The DSC® Brand Guidelines serve as the foundation for how we communicate our brand across every touchpoint. They define the visual and verbal elements that make DSC® recognizable, from our logo, colors, and typography to our voice, messaging, and storytelling.

Consistency helps build trust, but great brands also evolve. These guidelines are intended to provide direction and alignment while allowing room for creativity, innovation, and thoughtful adaptation. Use them to ensure everything we create reflects the values, expertise, and personality of the DSC® brand.

Table of Contents

Introduction

Brand Foundation

Who We Are

Taking Foam Further™

Positioning

Brand Pillars & Ethos

Mission & Vision

Product Architecture

Voice & Tone

Visual Identity

Logo Usage & Lockups

Color Palette

Typography

Imagery & Iconography

Graphic Elements

Brand Application

Business Collateral

Digital Guidelines

Social Media Guidelines

Resources

File Deliverables

Resources

Brand Foundation

Who We Are

Founded in 1945, DSC® is a family-owned advanced materials innovation partner with more than 80 years of expertise in foam technology, chemical engineering, and manufacturing. What began as a foam engineering company has evolved into a global organization helping brands create products that deliver meaningful comfort, performance, and functionality.

Through our proprietary platforms, DREAMCELL®, DPX®, and MORPH™, we develop advanced foam and composite solutions designed to solve real-world challenges and enhance how people move, perform, and experience everyday life.

With manufacturing locations and innovation centers across Asia and North America, DSC® combines global scale with local support to help partners bring better products to market faster. Guided by our commitment to Taking Foam Further™, we bring together material science, manufacturing expertise, and collaborative development to turn innovative ideas into reality.

Supported data / visuals:

8 Manufacturing Locations

81+ Years of chemical engineering and foam manufacturing experience

DREAMCELL®, DPX®, and Morph™ Product Platforms

Mission & Vision

Our **mission** guides how we work today. Our **vision** reflects the future we are working toward.

Mission:

To shape the future of foam innovation by engineering advanced material solutions that improve how people move, perform, and live while helping global partners bring better products to market through responsible innovation and manufacturing.

Vision:

To advance the future of movement through innovative material technologies that help create more functional, comfortable, and responsible products.

Taking Foam Further™

At DSC®, Taking Foam Further™ is more than a tagline. It reflects our commitment to continuously advancing material innovation, solving real-world challenges, and helping our partners create better products.

For us, taking foam further means:

Innovation

Pushing the boundaries of material science and foam technology.

Performance

Creating solutions that enhance comfort, functionality, and human movement.

Partnership

Working alongside customers from concept through production.

Progress

Continuously improving products, processes, and possibilities.

Global Readiness

Delivering local support backed by global manufacturing expertise.

Brand Pillars & Ethos

Our Ethos

At DSC, leadership is grounded in integrity, optimism, and accountability. We lead ourselves first, pursue mastery, and work together with humility and confidence to deliver results that go above and beyond.

Pillars:

01. Integrity First

We hold ourselves to a high standard in how we operate, make decisions, and work with others.

02. Default Positive

We approach challenges and relationships with a constructive mindset that helps us move forward together.

03. Humble Confidence

We stand behind our expertise and quality while remaining open, respectful, and grounded.

04. Passion for Innovation

We continuously seek better solutions that solve real challenges and create meaningful impact.

05. Above and Beyond

We exceed expectations for our clients, partners, and each other through dedication and teamwork.

Brand Pillars reference

03 MESSAGING PILLARS

Four things we always say.

Every campaign, landing page, and pitch deck should touch at least one pillar. Lead with the pillar closest to the client's current pain.

PILLAR 01

Human Orchestration.

We move fast without breaking things. Decades of expertise, AI where it helps, humans where it matters. You're never handed off to a bot.

PILLAR 02

Anything is possible.

Custom software that was out of reach is not just possible. It's easier than ever with the right partner. We make the possible, practical.

PILLAR 03

Long-term advisors.

We don't work for clients. We work alongside them. Governance, compliance, and future-thinking are part of the engagement, not an add-on.

PILLAR 04

Make an impact.

We value value. We untangle messy stacks and unclear analytics and drive efficiency, pipeline, and long-term benefit.

Product Architecture

At the core of DSC® are three proprietary material platforms: DREAMCELL®, DPX®, and MORPH™. By combining advanced foam technologies with customizable composite solutions, we help brands transform ideas into high-performance material packages tailored to their specific product needs.

Product Architecture - DREAMCELL

DREAMCELL®

Positioning Statement:

DREAMCELL® delivers breathable, all-day comfort through advanced open-cell foam design.

Story:

DREAMCELL® is DSC's comfort-driven, open-cell foam platform, designed to improve how people feel throughout their day. Built with comfort and breathability at its core, DREAMCELL® delivers a soft, adaptive feel that promotes airflow and long-term wearability.

It is engineered for applications where all-day comfort, recovery, and consistent feel matter most. Whether used in footwear or other products, DREAMCELL® enhances comfort and supports a more natural, effortless experience from morning to night.

Each DREAMCELL® variant enhances comfort in a different way, while maintaining a consistent core experience.

Product Architecture - DPX

DURAPONTEX®

Positioning Statement:

DPX® powers high-performance products through advanced, responsive, closed-cell foam technology.

Story:

DPX is DSC's high-performance foam platform, built for energy return, durability, and precision. Engineered using advanced processes such as supercritical fluid foaming, DPX materials deliver consistent, responsive performance in demanding environments.

It is developed for applications where performance, resilience, and efficiency are critical. From athletic footwear to technical components, DPX enhances movement by providing structure, responsiveness, and long-term durability.

Each DPX variant is engineered to enhance performance in a specific way, while maintaining a consistent core experience.

Product Architecture - MORPH

MORPH

Tagline: More Than Foam.

Positioning Statement:

MORPH is DSC's adaptable materials platform, combining advanced foam technology with engineered material constructions designed around the needs of each application.

Story:

Every material begins with a real need. Inspired by the way people move through everyday life, MORPH gives brands the freedom to create engineered material architectures that deliver the right balance of comfort, breathability, support, and movement for every application.

MORPH is DSC's customizable materials platform, designed to help those ideas evolve into finished products. By combining DREAMCELL® and DPX advanced foam technologies with flexible construction options, MORPH adapts to the unique requirements of each application.

Whether delivered as molded components, sheets, or fully integrated material systems, MORPH helps brands create solutions engineered for comfort, performance, functionality, and design freedom.

Because the best products are built from material systems engineered to work together.

Voice and Tone

Goal: to maintain consistency in messaging across print, web, and social media for our audience of designers, developers and engineers who use our materials in their product.

- **Brand Personality:** Humble and confident, combining practical ingenuity with evidence-based expertise built on more than 80 years of material innovation and manufacturing experience.
 - Wise. Trustworthy. Curious. Technical. Collaborative.
- **Brand Voice:** Clear, precise, and trustworthy. DSC communicates with confidence, using facts, expertise, and real-world insights to explain how materials improve products and experiences. We lead with substance, not hype.
- **Writing Style Guidelines:**
 - Lead with facts and data
 - Use clear, plain language and active voice
 - Support claims with data, testing, standards or real-world validation whenever possible
 - Focus on outcomes and experiences, not just technical specifications.
 - Avoid hype, superlatives, and overpromising
 - Be informative and approachable, not overly academic or overly promotional.
 - Use correct product names, trademarks, and technical terminology consistently.

We Do

- Explain technical concepts simply
- Connect materials to real-world outcomes
- Write for humans first, engineers second

We Don't

- Lead with jargon
- Overuse acronyms
- Make claims without evidence

Visual Identity

Logo Usage

- **Primary Logos:**
 - Provide the full-color versions and where/how they should be used
 - i. DSC 1945
 - ii. Taking Foam Further
 - 1. Provide stacked version
 - iii. Durapontex
 - iv. Dreamcell
 - v. Run the Relay
- **Alternate Logos:**
 - Horizontal, stacked, black & white, icon-only versions
- **Clear Space & Minimum Size:**
 - Define required spacing around the logo and minimum print/digital size
- **Incorrect Usage Examples:**
 - Show a few “don’ts” (e.g. stretching, changing colors, applying effects) - make sure it’s ® instead of ™

Color Palette, Branding Colors

- **Primary Colors:**
 - HEX, RGB, CMYK, Pantone codes
- **Secondary/Accent Colors:**
 - HEX, RGB, CMYK, Pantone codes
- **Usage Guidelines:**
 - When and where each color should be used (e.g. backgrounds, accents, call-to-action buttons)
 - RTR = green color, etc.

Typography

- **Primary Font(s):**
 - Name, styles (bold, regular, italic), and usage examples (headings, body text)
- **Secondary Font(s):**
 - Supporting typefaces, web-safe alternatives
- **Hierarchy:**
 - Heading levels (H1, H2, H3, etc.) and body formatting (size, spacing)

**current fonts for logos, come up with a complimentary font for Trade show booth displays and powerpoints that are universally accessible for global teams + anyone editing a PPT themselves

Business Collateral

- **Letterhead Design:**
 - Logo placement, margins, font styles, line spacing
- **Email Signature Format:**
 - Layout, contact info, logo/icon placement (tutorial and links to google drive to set up your own email signature)
- **Business Cards:**
 - Front/back design, required info, and logo usage
 - Matte vs. glossy
 - Rounded corners
- **Presentation Templates:**
 - PowerPoint or Google Slides style guidelines (title slide, content slide, etc.)
 - **Include SOP word document with formal process for Sales and Marketing collaboration (sales can edit their own ppt but marketing needs to approve it before use, at least XYZ days before, etc.) - included in Resources section at the end of the document

Brand Application

Digital Guidelines

- **Website Style:**
 - Header styles, buttons, forms, typography, image usage
- **Social Media Assets:**
 - Profile photos, cover images, post templates, highlight icons
- **Favicon/Icon Usage:**
 - Sizing and variations

Social Media Guidelines

Employee participation helps strengthen and humanize the DSC brand. We encourage team members to engage with and share DSC content while contributing their own authentic perspectives in a professional and responsible manner.

DO

- Share official DSC® content.
- Add your own perspective when reposting.
- Be professional, respectful, and authentic.
- Contact Marketing with ideas or questions.
- Obtain approval before creating DSC-focused content.

DON'T

- Share confidential information.
- Make unapproved claims.
- Discuss customers or brands without approval.
- Engage in political or inappropriate discussions while representing DSC.

Safe AI Practices

AI can be a valuable tool for improving efficiency, brainstorming ideas, and supporting everyday work. Use AI responsibly and always follow DSC's confidentiality, security, and brand standards.

DO

- Review every AI-generated output before using or sharing it.
- Verify facts, technical information, and product claims using trusted sources.
- Treat AI as a starting point, not the final answer.
- Opt out of AI model training or data usage whenever the platform allows.
- Use only approved DSC AI accounts for work-related tasks.
- Sign the required employee AI waiver and complete all required privacy settings before using a DSC AI account.
- Follow the same approval process for AI-generated content, images, and code as any other DSC-created material.
- Contact Marketing or IT if you have questions about appropriate AI use.

DON'T

- Enter confidential, proprietary, customer, supplier, employee, or financial information into public AI tools.
- Upload unreleased product information, contracts, pricing, strategic plans, or other sensitive business materials.
- Use personal AI accounts for confidential DSC work.
- Publish AI-generated content without human review and required approvals.
- Assume AI-generated information is accurate without verifying it.
- Present AI-generated content as fact without confirming the source.

Remember: AI should enhance your work, not replace your expertise. Every AI-generated output must be reviewed by a human before it is shared internally or externally. Use AI to support creativity, efficiency, and problem-solving while protecting DSC's information, customers, and reputation.

Imagery & Iconography

- **Photo Style Guidelines:**
 - Mood, tone, subject matter, filters, composition
- **Icon Style:**
 - Flat, outlined, filled, stroke weight, color use
- **Do's and Don'ts:**
 - DO - Keep it consistent with the tone and brand values
 - DON'T - Use brand logos on DSC® promotional materials
 - DON'T - Use third-party logos on website, social posts, ads, brochures, trade show signage, case studies, or press materials.
 - DON'T - Place another brand's logo next to the DSC® logo in public materials without a signed co-branding agreement.
 -
- **DSC® Promotional Products**
 - Always use the official **DSC® logo**
 - When referring to the company name in branding, use the official **DSC® logo** rather than spelling out **DSC** in plain text.
 - The **Taking Foam Further** logo is a supporting brand element and must always be paired with the official DSC® logo.

Photo Do's and Don'ts

- People and privacy: no photos of individuals without written consent or a signed release.
- Factory imagery: shoot only in approved areas and obtain site approval before sharing.
- Brands and IP: do not show third-party logos, labels, or confidential documents; crop or cover if unavoidable.
- Product focus: images should highlight DSC products and materials, with clean, uncluttered staging.
- Sample quality: use defect-free foam only; no blemishes, tears, color streaks, or density inconsistencies.
- Handling standards: no bare hands on raw foam or materials; use clean gloves or tools.
- Lighting and color: use even, neutral lighting; avoid harsh shadows and color casts; maintain consistent white balance.

Resources

File Deliverables

- **Logos:**
 - .AI, .EPS, .SVG, .PNG (transparent), .JPG
- **Fonts:**
 - Licensed files or Google Font links
- **Templates:**
 - Editable files for business card, letterhead, etc.
- **Brand Guidelines Document:**
 - PDF + editable version (if needed)

**** Ask Teena to confirm: For Print: High quality PDF or Adobe art files**

Resources

**add link for SOP approval process for powerpoints (Marketing needs to approve any edits made, 7-10 days before, etc.)